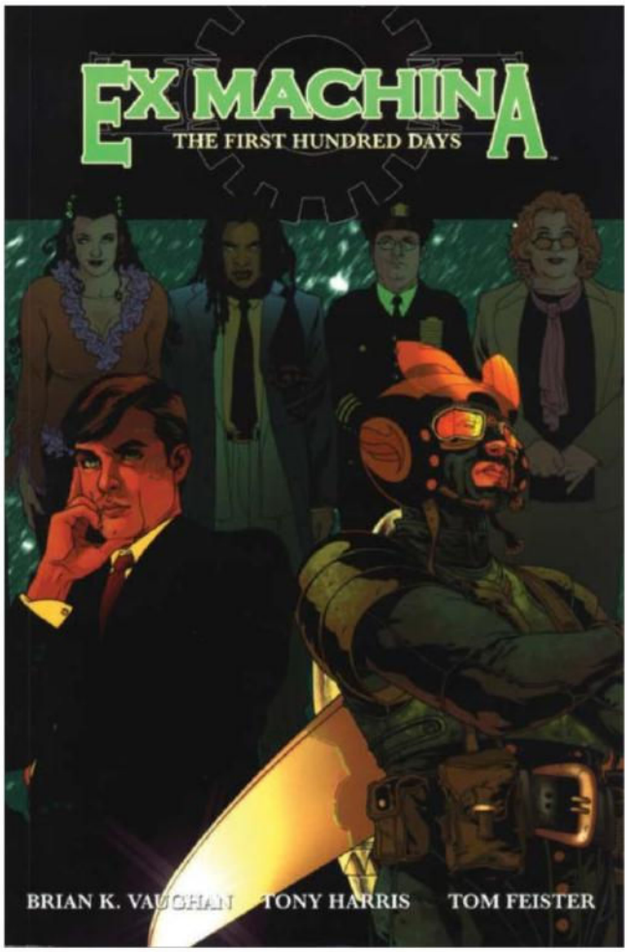


EX MACHINA: THE FIRST HUNDRED DAYS

Details **Originally published** Ex Machina #1-5 (2004) **Publisher** Wildstorm **Writer** Brian K Vaughan **Artist** Tony Harris **Collected in** Ex Machina: The First Hundred Days **Available digitally** Comixology, Marvel Unlimited

Given the subject matter, you'd be forgiven for thinking that *Ex Machina*'s appeal doesn't extend past its shock culture origins. The story revolves around Mitchell Hundred, a man with the ability to communicate and control machines. This strange power turns him into New York's first superhero as he stops the second plane from colliding with the World Trade Centre on 9/11. But it quickly becomes apparent that writer Brian K Vaughan set his sights on something much larger in scope than another superhero story.



Hundred, or The Great Machine as he is later known, runs for mayor of New York, and the book evolves into a sleek political thriller. *The First Hundred Days* is a great introduction to this world, as Vaughan delicately explores what it means for such a powerful and unknown figure to stand in such a position of power. *Ex Machina* might not be *Y: The Last Man* writer Vaughan's most popular series, but it is arguably his finest.

AMERICAN VAMPIRE VOL 1

Details **Originally published** American Vampire #1-5 (2010) **Publisher** DC Vertigo **Writer** Scott Snyder **Artist** Rafael Albuquerque **Collected in** American Vampire: Volume One **Available digitally** Comixology

F Scott Fitzgerald and John Steinbeck by way of Anne Rice and *Near Dark*, Scott Snyder and Rafael Albuquerque's Eisner-Award winning *American Vampire* is the first big Vertigo epic of the 21st Century and has Stephen King's input to prove it, with the master of Maine writing a whole issue – his comic-book debut with another creator's toys.

Spanning the American Century and weaving vampire mythology and American folklore into a blood-soaked tapestry that links the Wild West of undead outlaw Skinner Sweet with the exploitative Jazz Age Los Angeles of would-be starlet Pearl Jones, newly fanged-up and stubbornly straddling the world of the living and dead as she tries to carve out an unlife of her own.



Frantically paced, viciously playful and with visceral, urgent art from Albuquerque, there's nothing sparkly about *American Vampire*.

"THERE IS NOTHING SPARKLY ABOUT AMERICAN VAMPIRE"

